

Sociology

(A Level, AQA)

Sociology studies the structure, dynamics and 'functioning' of society. Studying sociology offers insights into social and cultural issues. It helps students develop a multi-perspective and critical approach to understanding issues around identity, education, poverty, religion, crime, culture and inequality. The Sociology A level course enables students to develop a number of new skills, including how to:

- use evidence to present arguments
- investigate facts and use deduction
- understand the world around you
- put over your point of view fluently
- be critical of the news/media

As an academic discipline Sociology demands the ability to cope with a variety of theoretical perspectives and the need to be able to write well-structured and evaluative essays. Teaching methods include class discussion, presentations and evaluation of sociological theories and research studies. Written work will be regularly set and students will need to spend time out of lessons consolidating knowledge through wider reading and practising extended writing/essays.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in GCSE Sociology (or Grade 5 in GCSE English if Sociology not previously studied)

Course content

Units	%	When?	Content
Paper 1	33.3%	May/June of Year 13	Two-hour exam. Short and extended writing questions on the topics of Education and Methods in Context (of Education). Extended writing question on Theories and Methods in Sociology. All these topics are compulsory.
Paper 2	33.3%	May/June of Year 13	Two-hour exam. Extended writing questions on the optional topics. Section A: Families and Households (studied in Year 12). Section B: The Media (studied in Year 13).
Paper 3	33.3%	May/June of Year 13	Two-hour exam. Short and extended writing questions on the topic of Crime and Deviance. Extended writing question on Theories and Methods in Sociology. All these topics are compulsory.

Career Links

Sociology is a great choice of subject for people who want a career in the public sector, such as the Police, Social Work, Nursing or Medicine. However, the subject is also useful in a number of other careers, like Marketing, Advertising, PR, Journalism, Law or Teaching.

For more information please contact Mrs Milsom

